



Welcome to Threl

A PUBLIC INTRODUCTION FROM IRON VEIL PRESS

A word from The Warden

Ah now, traveler—ye've found the road tae Threl.

'Tis not a gentle road, and I'll not dress it up as one. Threl be a world holdin' itself together by vow, by memory, by song, and by the stubborn hands o' folk refusin' to let the dark have the final word. Here, a city, it be more than stone, and prayer, 'tis more than breath. A name, spoken wrong or in the wrong hour, may carry weight enough to change what stands before ye.

Mind ya, there be beauty here. Fierce beauty. A lantern burnin' against an impossible night. A stranger offerin' bread at the edge o' the Fray. A chapel bell soundin' across a city that ought tae have vanished centuries ago. Threl be wounded, sure—but divil a bit empty.

So come closer now. Learn the shape o' the world, the price o' keepin' it, and the dangers waitin' beyond the light. The road be open. Walk it wisely, and bring a steady heart.

—The Warden

What is Threl?

Threl is a grimdark Christian tabletop role-playing setting about faith, reality, survival, and the cost of preserving what remains. It is a world where the boundaries between spiritual truth and physical existence have grown perilously thin, and where communities must work together to keep the world from unravelin'.

The age is marked by the failure of the **Grand Monochord** during the **Great Decoherence**. Since that catastrophe, reality no longer feels entirely fixed. The laws that once seemed permanent now require vigilance, language, memory, and communal effort to remain stable. Mountains still rise. Rivers still run. Fire still burns. But none of these things are taken for granted.

Threl is a setting for journeys through haunted wilderness, tense city politics, theological conflict, dangerous discovery, and difficult moral choices. Its stories ask what people owe one another when the world itself cannot be trusted to remain whole.

Dabar: the language beneath the world

At the heart of Threl lies **Dabar**, an ancient language bound to the structure of existence. Dabar is not ordinary spellcraft. It is a way of engaging with the underlying order of reality—the hidden pattern by which matter, motion, memory, and meaning hold together.

Those who study Dabar do not simply throw power into the world. They work through resonance, discipline, understanding, and intent. A phrase may reinforce a boundary, preserve a fragile object, guide a living process, or reveal a truth hidden beneath appearances. The greater the change demanded of reality, the greater the resistance and danger.

Dabar is therefore treated with reverence and caution. Words are not harmless in Threl. A careless phrase can do more than offend a listener; it can disturb the conditions that allow a place, a person, or a memory to remain what it is.

The language is also a source of division. The great institutions of Threl disagree over whether reality should be preserved, renewed, interpreted, or transformed. Each tradition claims to understand a portion of the truth. None can safely claim the whole of it.

The Anchors: cities that endure



An Anchor endures through the continual care of its people.

The settled cities of Threl are known as **Anchors**. These Scriptorum-Cities are built around places where the physical and spiritual orders meet in a fragile balance. Their great halls, towers, inscriptions, and rituals help maintain a region in which ordinary laws can continue to function.

Within an Anchor, gravity behaves as expected, water follows its course, and a wall remains a wall. Yet stability is never effortless. The cities depend upon perpetual maintenance, careful observance, and the labor of those who speak, inscribe, build, heal, teach, and watch.

Life in an Anchor is shaped by duty. Citizens live close to the machinery of preservation, and many have grown accustomed to measuring safety by the strength of the local resonance. The city offers shelter, but it also imposes rules. Dissent, spiritual exhaustion, and uncertainty can become matters of public concern when one person's instability threatens the safety of many.

Every Anchor carries the character of its founders. Some are severe and stone-bound. Others are luminous, scholarly, or given to music and debate. All are temporary victories against the unravellin' dark.

The Fray: the unspooled wilds



Beyond the last dependable light, the world begins to lose its shape.

Beyond the protection of the Anchors lies **the Fray**.

The Fray is not merely a wilderness. It is a region where definitions have weakened and the world has become uncertain. Distance may deceive. Time may fold. Familiar things may take on unfamiliar meanings. In some places, sound may feel solid; in others, memory may cling to the landscape like weather.

Travel through the Fray requires preparation, restraint, and company. Explorers carry **Seal-Lanterns** and other Dabar-worked instruments to maintain a small pocket of dependable reality. They watch the sky, the ground, and one another for signs that the surrounding world is beginning to rewrite what they know.

The greatest danger is not always a beast or an ambush. Sometimes it is the slow loss of certainty: a path that no longer leads where it began, a face that cannot be remembered, or a name that no longer belongs to the person who carried it. In the Fray, survival depends upon more than strength. It depends upon attention, trust, and the courage to recognize when the world has changed.

Scarred Nodes and the Green Rot

Where the Great Decoherence tore reality most deeply, it left behind **Scarred Nodes**. These places are persistent wounds in the world—regions where the damage cannot be fully repaired by ordinary rites or city-chanting.

Scarred Nodes draw in instability. Their influence may appear as distorted landscapes, impossible echoes, or the growth known as the **Green Rot**. The Rot is more than a physical corruption. It erodes definitions. It can make an object forget its shape, cause a familiar tool to become something else, or turn the remnants of a place into a record of what it once was.

Scarred Nodes are feared, but they are also coveted. They contain forms of **Unbound Glimmer**, a dangerous residue used in advanced artifice and other works that ordinary materials cannot support. Those who harvest it may keep a city's systems alive, but the price can be measured in memory, identity, and the risk of never returnin' whole.

The Three Orders

The religious and civic life of Threl is shaped by three great perspectives commonly associated with the **Father, the Son, and the Spirit**. These are not simple factions, and no single institution speaks for every believer. They are traditions of interpretation, practice, and responsibility.

Aspect	Public character	Central concern
The Father	Law, stasis, judgment, and enduring structure	How can what remains be preserved?
The Son	Grace, virtue, movement, and the care of living souls	How can people remain connected and choose rightly?
The Spirit	Mystery, transformation, discernment, and the unseen	What must be understood before the next change arrives?

The three perspectives often cooperate in crisis, but they do not agree about the future. One tradition may seek to anchor the world until restoration becomes possible. Another may believe that renewal must be composed through virtuous action. Another may study the wounds of existence in the hope of discerning what lies beyond them.

These disagreements are not background decoration. They shape law, medicine, education, art, exploration, and the daily lives of ordinary people. In Threl, theology is lived in the street, carved into the wall, sung in the great halls, and argued over beside the fire.

The Ironveil

The **Ironveil** is a secular order of archivists, engineers, explorers, and re-indexers. Where the Church seeks primarily to preserve and anchor, the Ironveil seeks to recover lost knowledge and understand the structure of the broken world.

Its members maintain instruments, study old inscriptions, protect dangerous records, and venture beyond the safety of the Anchors. They believe that what has been lost may not be gone forever. If enough of the world’s knowledge can be recovered and understood, a path toward renewal may yet be found.

The Ironveil is not free from ambition, disagreement, or error. Its work brings it into conflict with religious authorities, desperate communities, rival scholars, and forces that would rather see the past remain buried. Yet when a lantern must be repaired, a lost road charted, or an impossible record interpreted, the Ironveil is often the last order standing between discovery and disaster.

The people of Threl

Threl is inhabited by people who have learned to build ordinary lives beside extraordinary danger. Chant-clergy keep watch over the great halls. Artisans maintain wards and lanterns. Healers tend bodies and spirits. Scholars preserve fragments of history. Node-harvesters risk the Fray to gather the resources that keep the cities alive. Travelers carry news between communities that may otherwise never hear one another’s voices.

Some people are born within the protection of an Anchor and never leave it. Others make their living on the boundary, where the last stable road gives way to uncertainty. Some are drawn toward the Fray by duty, desperation, faith, curiosity, or the promise of knowledge. Every one of them must decide what is worth preserving—and what price may be paid for it.

Stories waiting on the road

A Threl campaign may begin in a stable city or at the edge of a Scarred Node. The characters may be pilgrims, mercenaries, scholars, clergy, artisans, scouts, exiles, or people who simply have nowhere else to go. They may be charged with recovering a lost inscription, escorting a lantern caravan, investigating a new wound in reality, settling a dispute between Orders, or uncovering the truth behind a place that should not exist.

The setting supports stories of exploration, survival, investigation, spiritual struggle, political tension, and hard-won hope. The threats are tangible, but the deepest questions are personal:

What do ye hold onto when the world forgets its own shape?

What does faith require when certainty be gone?

What would ye risk tae preserve a single life, a single truth, or a single light?

The road ahead

Well now, that be enough tae set yer feet upon the road—but divil a bit enough tae tell ye where it ends.

Threl be a world o' broken harmony and stubborn hope. Its ruins hold warnings. Its cities hold promises. Its wilds hold truths that may not wish tae be found. The choices o' travelers matter, for the world be not merely waitin' tae be explored. It be waitin' tae see what kind o' folk will shape what comes next.

So take up yer lantern. Keep close tae those ye trust. Speak careful. Listen longer than ye talk. And when the road turns dark, remember this:

A small light be still a light, so it be.

God willin', I'll meet ye farther down the road, so I will.

—The Warden